FRANÇOIS BARES

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford ◇ Park End Street, Oxford OX1 1HP, United Kingdom
email ◇ (+44) 7759 335022 ◇ website

EDUCATION

DPhil (PhD) in Finance, Saïd Business School, University of Oxford *2022–2026*
Thesis: *Three Essays on the Production of Knowledge*
Committee: Thomas Hellmann (chair), Kyle Myers, Seung Joo Lee
Green Templeton College; full scholarship

Visiting PhD Student, Harvard Business School *2025*
Hosted by Kyle Myers; affiliated with the Laboratory for Innovation Science at Harvard (LISH)

MS in Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison *2020–2022*
First two years of the PhD programme; full scholarship

MSc in Economics, London School of Economics *2017–2018*

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Where Should Science Funding Go? Estimating Marginal Returns to Public Funding Across Research Fields" *2026*

Science funding is shrinking in many countries, while commercial innovation increasingly relies on publicly funded science. I study the optimal allocation of science funding across fields. I estimate marginal returns to funding in 19 biomedical fields using a micro-founded structural model where scientists compete for grants. These scientists differ in productivity and shift their research focus towards better-funded fields. Once funded, they produce knowledge by combining grant funding with existing knowledge from their own and other fields, giving rise to knowledge spillovers. Marginal returns vary widely across fields: an additional $1 million yields 2.2 publications in Nursing Research and 14.8 in Human Genome. Knowledge spillovers account for most of this gap. Upstream fields, such as General Medicine and Human Genome, generate far larger spillovers than specialised downstream fields, such as Nursing Research or Deafness and Communication Disorders. Scientists do move towards better-funded fields, but their replacements are equally productive once funded, so this reallocation costs little in equilibrium. I construct three welfare-relevant measures of scientific output: academic impact, commercial potential and disease-burden reduction. Marginal-return rankings barely change across the three measures. I combine each measure with the estimated marginal returns from the model to compare the current allocation with two counterfactual allocations: allocating funding in proportion to disease burden, as the medical community often advocates, and in proportion to marginal returns, as the model suggests. Across the three measures, allocation based on the model estimates yields 39–54% more output than the current allocation and 15.1–26.4% more than disease-burden alignment.

Presented at: Oxford FAME Seminar; NBER Productivity Seminar; BDI–EIEF–CEPR Conference on Finance and Innovation.

OTHER PAPERS

"Innovation Prizes as Fundraising Signals: Evidence from XPRIZE Competitions" *2026*
With Thomas Hellmann, Elaine Hungenberg, and Andrew Tauhert

"Does Artificial Intelligence Democratize Science? Evidence from AlphaFold" *2026*
With Anantha Divakaruni and Ludovic Phalippou. Previously circulated as "AI-qualizing Science"

"The Impact of the Global Minimum Tax on Incentives for Business Location, Investment, and Profit Shifting" *2026*
With Michael Devereux, Irem Guceri, and Vikram Patil
Journal of International Business Studies, 57(7), 972–989

"The OECD Global Anti-Base Erosion Proposal" *2020*
With Michael Devereux, Sarah Clifford, Judith Freedman, Irem Guceri, Martin McCarthy, Martin Simmler, and John Vella
Report for PwC

WORK IN PROGRESS

"The Cost of Hormones: RCT Gender Balance and Drug Development"

"The Social Returns to R&D: Evidence from Cancer Research"
With Kyle Myers and Mai Anh Tran

"Capital Intensity and Risk Sharing in Deep-Tech Startups"
With Kyle Myers and Mai Anh Tran

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford *2024–2026*
Applied Financial Economics: *Support class lecturer* (master's, 2026)
Executive Finance: *Support class lecturer* (MBA, 2024, 2026)
Financial Accounting: *Support class lecturer* (MBA, 2025)
Financial Strategy: *Teaching assistant* (executive education, 2025)
Stanford University in Oxford *2024*
Game Theory and Financial Economics: *Tutor* (undergraduate)
Oriel College, University of Oxford *2023, 2024*
Economics of Information: *Summer school lecturer* (undergraduate, 2023, 2024)
Corporate Finance: *Summer school lecturer* (undergraduate, 2024)
University of Wisconsin–Madison *2022*
World Hunger and Malnutrition: *Teaching assistant* (undergraduate)

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistantships
Ramana Nanda, Imperial College London *2022–2023*
Thomas Hellmann, University of Oxford *2022–2023*
Andrew Stevens, University of Wisconsin–Madison *2021*
Paul Frijters, London School of Economics *2017–2018*

Centre for Business Taxation, University of Oxford *2018–2020*
Pre-doctoral Fellow
Worked on the tax treatment of corporate losses in the UK with large-scale administrative data.
Worked on business rates and their effects on commercial property use. Paper available here.
Co-authored a study on the optimality of combining a patent box with an R&D tax credit policy.

Crédit Agricole S.A., Economic Research Division *2016*
Summer Intern
Specified and estimated macro-level models of corporate investment for the Eurozone and six of its member states (VAR models) and built the underlying database.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Research Fellowship in Finance, Saïd Business School *2026*
Graduate Scholarship, Saïd Business School *2022*
Green Templeton College–Saïd Business School DPhil Scholarship *2022*
Graduate Fellowship, University of Wisconsin–Madison *2020*

LANGUAGES AND TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

Programming	R, Stata, Python, LaTeX, Unix, Docker, Git, Query DSL, SQL
Data	Orbis, PATSTAT, Eurostat, OpenAlex, Dimensions.ai, NIH RePORTER, Google Patents, PitchBook, Nielsen Retail Scanner Accredited by the UK government to use confidential administrative data
Modelling	Game theory, discrete choice, supply chain networks, production functions
Statistics	Econometrics (parametric and non-parametric), machine learning (NLP)
Languages	French (native), English (fluent, C2), German (B2), Spanish (A2)

RECOMMENDATIONS

Thomas Hellmann
DP World Professor in Entrepreneurship and Innovation
Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, Park End Street, Oxford OX1 1HP, UK
thomas.hellmann@sbs.ox.ac.uk

Kyle Myers
Anna Spangler Nelson and Thomas C. Nelson Associate Professor of Business Administration
Harvard Business School, Boston, MA 02163, USA
kmyers@hbs.edu

Seung Joo Lee
Associate Professor of Finance
Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, Park End Street, Oxford OX1 1HP, UK
seung.lee@sbs.ox.ac.uk